



ANNIVERSARY

around the air vents chokes the air flow and reduces the life of your laptop drastically. Also, fans have to spin faster to keep things cool, and this drains the battery even more.

Avoid multi-tasking when running on battery power

Multi-tasking may be an efficient way of working if you have the hang of it, but it drains battery a lot faster. It's a lot better to prioritise your tasks, and open the software you need to accomplish them one at a time. Most often, you will focus on one task, and all the other programs in the background sit there eating up CPU time, and as a result, battery power. If you're not using the internet, disable Wi-Fi and the LAN connection. Bluetooth, Wi-Fi and IR radios drain a lot of power, which is why there are shortcut keys to turn them off; use those keys often.

Battery saving tips for mobiles and tablets

Know when to turn off stuff

With cellphones and tablets, it is quite common to keep Wi-Fi, 3G, bluetooth, GPS and other things constantly on and forget about it. But each of these features employ particular components / radios which are doing work in the background and in effect keep sipping the battery. If you are using all of these functions (highly likely) then there's nothing to be done, but be ready to see your battery drain very quickly. You need to use these features judiciously to ensure you are getting what you want and at the same time not causing drastic drop in the battery levels. For instance, if you have a Wi-Fi only tablet, keep the Wi-Fi adapter off when you are commuting. Leaving it on will mean the Wi-Fi adapter keeps searching for open Wi-Fi networks, and drain battery.

GPS is another enemy to your battery. Most apps which request your location such as Zomato, Instagram, Fourquare, etc., to provide you location-specific information should be used only when you need them rather than keeping the GPS in an always-on mode

Detach from physical drives, save in the cloud

Utility / Application Name	Dropbox	Google Drive	iCloud	SkyDrive	
Free Storage offered	2 GB	5 GB	5 GB	7 GB	
Referral bonus storage	Y	N	N	N	
Windows Client	Y	Y	Y	Y	
Mac Client	Y	Y	Y	Y	
Linux Client	Y	N	N	N	
Android Client	Y	Y	N	Y	
iOS Client	Y	Y	Y	Y	
BB Client	Y	N	N	N	
Windows Phone/RT Client	N	N	N	Y	
File / Folder Collaboration	Y	Y	N	Y	
Limit on no of downloads	N	N	N	N	
Public File Sharing	Y	Y	N	Y	
File Encryption	Y	Y	Y	Y	
Password Protection	N	N	N	N	
Download to mobile	Y	Y	Y	Y	
Version History	Y	Y	N	Y	

especially if you have a battery life of under 15 per cent remaining. You can go to Settings > Location Services and turn all location services off. Whenever you open an app that needs your location, you will get a prompt requesting location access. Depending on your battery life, you can choose to take the call instead of letting the dumb device decide for you.

Check what's using battery life

For Android tablets and phones: Go to Settings > Battery. This will give you an indication of the battery life consumed by applications and services. You can force stop any unwanted application or service if you don't like what it does to your battery levels.

Also whether on iOS, Windows or Android, uninstall any apps that you hardly ever use.

Lower timeout/auto-lock limit

In Android phones and tablets, the screen time-out starts from 15 seconds and in Apple devices the screen time-out starts from 1 minute. Keeping this at the

lowest setting ensures that your screen turns off soon after you've stopped using the device. The display is one of the major drains on batteries, so it's best to allow it to power down quicker. Besides, you might forget to click the standby button, which will cause the device to remain fully powered on for a full minute or so, and eating battery.

Also remember to keep your display at a low brightness setting when you need the battery to last longer. If you're going outside, and are nowhere close to a charging spot, allowing the device to automatically adjust brightness might cause it to set the brightness level too high, which will eat battery away faster. It's additional work for you, but you should take the call when to increase screen brightness.

Upload and sync only on Wi-fi

Ensure that you keep the syncing and app update settings to Wi-Fi only, unless you are in a extreme hurry to get your Dropbox synced with your office system. Uploading or downloading heavy files using a data connection while com-